

**KNOWLEDGE AND PRACTISES REGARDING MENSTRUAL HYGIENE
AMONG GRADE 9 TO GRADE 11 SCHOOL GIRLS IN GOVERNMENT
SCHOOLS IN KILINOCHCHI DISTRICT, SRILANKA**

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KNOWLEDGE AND PRACTISES REGARDING MENSTRUAL HYGIENE AMONG GRADE 9 TO GRADE 11 SCHOOL GIRLS IN GOVERNMENT SCHOOLS IN KILINOCHCHI DISTRICT, SRILANKA

Abstract

Managing menstrual hygiene is important in terms of female health, however it is poorly being addressed in developing countries. The aim of this study is to determine the status of knowledge and menstrual hygiene practices among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls. This will be a conducted as a descriptive cross-sectional study among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi District. 375 such students who have attained menarche at the time of survey will be selected using a multi-stage probability sampling method. Relevant associations of menstrual hygiene with socio demographic characteristics, knowledge and self-care practices will be analyzed using the chi square test. A p value of less than or equal to 0.05 will be considered as significant. Ethical clearance will be obtained from the ethical review committee of the National Institute of Health Science (NIHS), Kaluthara. The study is expected to provide necessary information regarding menstrual hygiene knowledge and practices among adolescent girls, thus generating evidence on the requirement of menstrual hygiene lessons in education curricula and the necessity in incorporating menstrual hygiene management in WASH programmes in schools.

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Background

Menstruation is a part of the female reproductive cycle that starts when they become sexually mature at the time of puberty. It is important that females are able to manage menstrual hygiene. However, menstrual hygiene management is insufficiently acknowledged and has not received adequate attention in the reproductive health sectors in developing countries and its impact on achieving several Millennium Development Goals (WaterAid, 2009). Globally, half of the female population is of reproductive age (UNICEF, 2011) and at any given time, 25% of the female population is menstruating (Adhikari, 2007). Menstruation is a natural process in a woman's life and needs special care from a physical and psychological point of view (Abera, 2004). In order for females to live healthy productive and dignified lives, it is essential that they are able to manage menstrual bleeding hygienically (Mahon *et al.*, 2010).

In Bangladesh, a study showed that 95% of women and 90% of adolescent girls use rags during menstruation to absorb the flow of menstrual blood. The same study showed that 40% of women change their rags only once a day, 60% of women wash the rags in unsafe water and 80% of adolescent girls' reuse the rag (Ahmed *et al.*, 2011). In a study in Thiruvananthapuram city of south India, 45.5% reported using sanitary pads alone as menstrual absorbent, 38.2% use both cloth and sanitary pads and 16.3% cloth alone; 74.8% of adolescents changed sanitary towels/cloth 2–3 times a day (Renjit, 2012). United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) estimates that about 1 in 10 school age African girls do not attend school during menstruation or drop out at puberty because of the lack of clean and private sanitation facilities to manage their menstruation hygienically (UNICEF, 2011).

In Egypt because of cultural and religious beliefs, menstruation is not considered an appropriate topic of discussion, leading to the lack of accurate information for girls to manage menstruation hygienically. In poor areas of Egypt, there is a problem of overcrowding and poor infrastructure both in schools and homes. Toilets may be totally absent or few in number, with broken doors or defective water supply and sewerage (El-Gilany *et al.*, 2005). Menstrual hygiene needs to be addressed holistically and in context as a package of services that includes voice and space to talk about the issue, adequate water, privacy, facilities for washing and disposal of used sanitary pads (Tjon *et al.*, 2007).

The accessibility of private place to change their sanitary cloths or pads, clean water for washing hands and used cloths, and facilities for safely disposing of used materials affects the practice of menstrual hygiene (House *et al.*, 2012). Different studies indicate that good menstrual hygiene was practiced among those girls whose mothers were literate, girls studying in more than grade 10 in school, older girls, having prior knowledge about menstruation before menarche, presence of proper sanitary latrine at home, exposure to advertisements regarding usage of sanitary napkins in mass media, residential address and socioeconomic status of the family (Subhash *et*

al., 2011). In Egypt the significant predictors of use of sanitary pads were availability of mass media at home, high and middle social class and urban residence (El-Gilany *et al.*, 2005).

1.2 Justification

In many parts of the developing world, menstrual hygiene management is one of the critical challenges adolescent girls face while they are in school. This is largely due to lack of facilities as well as poor management of the existing facilities which is important for the management of menstrual hygiene (Tsegaye *et al.*, 2012).

Sri Lankan Government aims to provide universal sanitation coverage by 2020 and to mainstream menstrual hygiene management (MHM) through new water, sanitation and hygiene in schools (WinS) policies (Policy Repository of Ministry of Health, 2016). However, there is significant fragmentation of water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) responsibilities according to UNICEF in 2015. There are usually separate toilets for girls, however only 34% report using the toilet for changing sanitary materials. Due to poverty, many girls use rags/cloths instead of sanitary pads (UNICEF, 2016).

According to the 2015 KAP analysis in Kalutara district, a few schools were equipped with menstrual hygiene management facilities where, 60% of the teachers thought blood is impure; 80% thought bathing should be avoided; and 40% thought vaginal insertion of tampons has side effects (UNICEF, 2012). In Government-sponsored schools, there was 41% availability of soap and only 1% of principals and 6% of teachers stated that emergency sanitary pads were available (UNICEF, 2015). According to the research, 80% of girls were aware that they should bathe during menstruation (UNICEF, 2014) and 70% were aware they should wash menstrual cloths with soap and dry them before use to kill germs (MOE, 2015). Around 37% of girls miss at least one or two days of school each month due to their period and 66% are not aware of menstruation until menarche (UNICEF, 2014). Therefore, it is important to identify the practice of menstrual hygiene and associated factors among school going students to intervene accordingly. However, there is little known & scarce studies on knowledge, practices regarding menstrual hygiene and its associated factors among female students of Kilinochchi district. So, this study will expect to fulfil this gap and assess the knowledge, practices of menstrual hygiene and associated factors among adolescent school girls in Kilinochchi district, Sri Lanka.

1.3 Objectives

1.3.1 General Objective

- To determine the knowledge and practices regarding menstrual hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi District, Sri Lanka.

1.3.2 Specific Objectives

- To assess knowledge regarding menstrual hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi District, Sri Lanka.
- To assess practices regarding menstrual hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi District, Sri Lanka.
- To assess the factors associated with knowledge and practices regarding menstrual hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi District, Sri Lanka.

2.0 Materials and Methods

2.1 Study design

A descriptive cross-sectional study.

2.2 Study setting

Government schools in Kilinochchi district.

2.3 Study population

Study population would be grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi District.

Exclusion criteria: Those who have not attained menarche at the time of the survey.

2.4 Study Period

For a period of 10 months from March 2019 to January 2020.

2.5 Sample size and Calculation

Sample size determination will be through the following equation (Lwanga & Lemeshow, 1991).

$$n = z^2 P (1-P) / d^2$$

n- Sample size

z= critical value of specified confidence level (critical value of specified confidence level, for this study the confidence level will be set at 95% and thus the critical value is 1.96)

d= Desire precision (Desired precision, the variation expected for the anticipated level of knowledge with 95% confidence interval will be set at 5%)

P= estimated of the proportion

Prevalence of poor practices regarding menstrual hygiene will be considered as 33% according to the available literature when calculating the sample size (Kaluvarachchi *et al.*, 2017)

$$n = (1.96 \times 1.96 \times 33 \times 67) / 5 \times 5 = 340$$

A non-response rate of 10% will be expected, therefore final sample size will be 374 and it will be rounded as 375.

2.6 Sampling Technique

Multi-stage sampling method will be utilized as the sampling technique. The list of all Government schools with grade 9 to grade 11 classes in the Kilinochchi District will be obtained (63). Then a computer based random number generator will be used to select five schools to be included in the sample. Total sample size will be equally divided among selected schools ($375/5=75$). Therefore, the number of students to be recruited from each school will be 75. The selection of study subjects from each school will be done using a simple random method as per previous. If one school cannot reach the sample size, samples will be obtained from one additional school selected randomly.

2.7 Study Instruments

The questionnaire will be prepared in English and translated into Sinhala and Tamil. The questionnaire consists of multiple-choice and yes/no questions (Annexure IX, X and XI). The content validity of the questionnaire will be assessed by a panel of experts. Pre-testing of the questionnaire will be done among selected school girls of grade 9 to grade 11 in Jaffna district.

Questionnaire will consist of categories such as;

- Socio-demographic factors-age, religion, education level of mother and father, family monthly income, number of family members, access of covered toilet etc.
- Questions regarding menstrual pattern in adolescent school girls - age at menarche (yrs.), duration of blood flow (days) and length of cycle (days).
- Knowledge questions on menstruation (cause, origin of blood), menstrual hygienic practices and its effects etc.
- Practice questions toward type of absorbent, place of store and dry absorbents, frequency of changing pads per day, place where dispose used pads, frequency of washing genitalia and hands during menstruation, materials used for hand washing and cleaning genitalia etc.

2.8 Data Collection

Each selected school will be visited, and Principal and staff of schools will be briefed about the importance and usefulness of the study and required permission will be obtained. Schedule for visiting the schools and data collection from the students will be planned after considering the convenience of the school routines. The subjects who consented will be given a brief introduction on the purpose of the questionnaire and method of filling it with a request for honest responses. In a classroom setting asking and selecting only those who have attained menarche may cause unnecessary psychological and social hardship to someone yet to attain menarche. Therefore, to avoid such a scenario all students selected will be given the questionnaire. A specific question (question number 11) in the questionnaire will assess whether the participant has attained menarche or not. If there are any participants who have not attained menarche as per the filled questionnaire, a new one will be recruited using the same random method. Confidentiality will be assured. The subjects will be given the questionnaire in their preferred language (Tamil/English/Sinhala). Any doubts will be clarified immediately. On submission, questionnaire will be examined for inconsistencies and will be rectified. Once submitted, their queries will be addressed adequately with due acknowledgement for their participation.

2.9 Data Analysis

Data processing and analysis will be done using 'IBM SPSS Statistics' software package version 20. Independent variables will be the socio demographic factors and dependent variables will be knowledge and practice. Final score will be calculated in base of the percentage for each individual. Total scores being above 75 out of 100 will be mentioned to be favorable while scores being between 50% and 74% or lower than 50% will be reported as medium and poor knowledge and practice. Quantitative data will be summarized as mean, standard deviation, maximum, minimum and range. Qualitative data will be described as frequencies and percentages. Relevant associations of menstrual hygiene with socio demographic characteristics, knowledge and practice will be analyzed using the chi square test. A p value of less than or equal to 0.05 will be considered as significant.

2.10 Administrative Requirements

Permission from Zonal educational department and respective principals of each schools will be obtained.

2.11 Ethical Issues and Clearance

Ethical clearance will be obtained from the ethical review committee of the National Institute of Health Science (NIHS), Kalutara. Information sheet (Annexure III, IV and V) will be provided with all the necessary information to the participants thus giving the opportunity to ask questions as well. Participants have the rights to withdraw from the study at any time during the study process. Informed written consent (Annexure VI, VII and VIII) will be obtained prior to the self-administration of the questionnaire. The researcher will make sure the research will be conducted

with minimum stakeholders and participants. All data and questionnaires will be kept by the principal investigator. Data will be destroyed after two years of completion of study

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ANNEXURE I

Budget

Items estimated	Cost (LKR)
Stationery	1,000
Travel	3,000
Printing	2,000
Consumables	1,000
Miscellaneous	2,000
Clearance charges	3,000
Total	12,000

ANNEXURE II

Time Frame-Gantt Chart

Activity	March 2019	April 2019	May 2019	June 2019	July 2019	Aug 2019	Sep 2019	Oct 2019	Nov 2019	Dec 2019	Jan 2020
Literature survey											
Proposal writing											
Ethics clearance											
Planning data collection											
Data collection											
Data entry											
Data analysis											
Report writing											

ANNEXURE III

තොරතුරු පිටුව

කොළඹ කළමනාකරණ හා විද්‍යා විශ්වවිද්‍යාලයේ ජ්‍යෙෂ්ඨවේද්‍ය විද්‍යා ශිෂ්‍යාවක් උපාධිය හදාරන වන මා මාගේ අධ්‍යාපනයට අදාල පර්යේෂණ කටයුතු කිලිනොච්චි දිස්ත්‍රික්කයේ ඇති රජයේ පාසල්වලට යා යුතුව තිබේ. කිලිනොච්චි දිස්ත්‍රික්කයේ ඇති වසර 9 සිට 11 දක්වා අධ්‍යාපනය ලබන පාසැල් ශිෂ්‍යාවන් ගෙන් මාසික ඔසප් සමයේ සෞඛ්‍යය සම්බන්ධ දැනුම හා අනුගමනය කරන ක්‍රියා පිළිවෙත සම්බන්ධයෙන් වූ ඇගයීමක් සිදු කළ යුතුව තිබේ.

පර්යේෂණයේ අරමුණ

කාන්තාවක ගරුත්වය හා තෘප්තිමත් පෞද්ගලිකත්වයන් ප්‍රවර්ධනය කිරීමට තමන්ම තමාව සළකණ ක්‍රියා පිළිවෙතද ඔසප් සෞඛ්‍යයද මූලික අවශ්‍යතාවයක්වේ. එම නිසා කිලිනොච්චි දිස්ත්‍රික්කයේ වසර 9 සිට 11 දක්වා ඇති පාසල්වල (තුරුණු විය) වැඩි වියට පත්වූ ශිෂ්‍යාවන් අතුරු දක්නට ඇති මාසික ඔසප් කාලයේ සෞඛ්‍යය පිළිබඳ දැනුම හා පිළිවෙත් පිළිබඳව, නිරීක්ෂණය කිරීම අවශ්‍යවේ. මාසික ඔසප් කාලයේ සෞඛ්‍යය ඉතාමත් උසස් ප්‍රමිතියෙන් පවත්වා ගෙන යාම අනුගමනය කිරීම, ලිංගාශ්‍රිත ලා රෝගයන්හි කාර්යයක් ඉටු කෙරේ. බෝවන රෝග හා ගර්භාෂයේ මංවල පිළිකා රෝග වළක්වා ගැනීමෙහි ලා මෙම පර්යේෂණයේ අරමුණ ලෙස මෙම වියස් කාණ්ඩයේ ලමුන්ගේ ඔසප් කළමනාකරණය කෙරෙහි ආකල්ප වැඩිදියුණු කිරීම දැක්විය හැක.

ස්වේච්ඡා සහභාගීත්වය

මෙම පර්යේෂණයට ඔබගේ සහභාගීත්වය සම්පූර්ණයෙන් ස්වේච්ඡා සහගතවේ. මෙයට සහභාගීවීම හෝ නොවීම යන්න ඔබගේ තේරීමවේ. මෙම හැදෑරීමට ඔබ සහභාගී නොවීමට තීරණය කරන්නේ නම් ඔනෑම වේලාවක එය කළ හැකියි. කැමැත්ත පළ කිරීමෙන් පසුව පවා.

හදාරන කාල සීමාව හැදෑරීමේ ක්‍රියා පිළිවෙත හා සහභාගී වන අයගේ වගකීම

කිලිනොච්චි දිස්ත්‍රික්කයේ ඇති රජයේ පාසල්වල වසර 09 සිට 11 දක්වා අධ්‍යාපනය ලබන පාසැල් ශිෂ්‍යාවන් අතර පර්යේෂණය කිරීමට නියමිතයි. ඔබට ප්‍රශ්න කීපයක් අඩංගු පැන වැළඹ ලබා දෙනු ලැබේ. එම පැන වැළ සම්පූර්ණ කිරීමට ඔබට විනාඩි 5 - 15 ක් ගතවේ.

ලාභ සත්කාර

මෙම හැදෑරීමට සහභාගීවූ අයට මාසික ඔසප් සෞඛ්‍ය පිළිබඳව දැනුම හා ලිංගාශ්‍රිත ක්‍රියා පිළිවෙත බෝවන රෝග පිළිබඳව දැනුවත් කිරීම ප්‍රවර්ධනය කර ජීවන රටාව වෙනස් කර යහපත් සෞඛ්‍ය මඟ පෙන්වීමකින් ජීවත්වීමට උපකාරීවේ.

අනතුරු ආපදා හා අපහසුකම්

මෙම හැදෑරීමට සහභාගීවීම මඟින් ඔබට අනතුරක්, හානියක් හෝ අපහසුතාවයක් සිදු නොවේ.

පර්යේෂණයට සහභාගී වීම නැවැත්වීම

ඔබ දඩුවමකට හෝ වෛද්‍ය රැකවරණයේ බලපෑමක් හෝ සත්කාරවල අහිමිවීමක් හෝ කිසිවක් නොමැතිව මෙම හැදෑරීමෙහි සහභාගීත්වය පිළිබඳ කැමැත්ත, ඔනෑම වේලාවක නැවත ලබා ගත හැකියි. ඔබගේ කැමැත්ත නැවත ලබා ගැනීමට තීරණය කළ පසු එය නිරීක්ෂක වෙත දැන්වීමට කාරුණික වෙන්න.

වැය වූ දෑ යළි ලබා ගැනීම

මෙම පර්යේෂණයේ සහභාගීවීම සඳහා කිසිම දිරි මුදලක් ලබා දෙනු නොලැබේ.

පහදා දීම

සමහර වචන ඔබට තේරුම් ගත නොහැකිව තිබිය හැකියි. තොරතුරු පිළිබඳව පැහැදිලි කිරීමේදී තේරුම් ගත නොහැකි නම් මා හට පවසන්න. මා එය කාල පරාසයක් ගෙන පැහැදිලි කරන්නෙමි. ඔබ මාගෙන් ප්‍රශ්න ඇසිය යුතුව තිබේ නම් පසුව මාගෙන් අසා ගත හැකියි.

ANNEXURE IV

தகவல் தாள்

கொழும்பு முகாமைத்துவ அறிவியல் பல்கலைக்கழகத்தில் உயிரியல் விஞ்ஞான பட்டதாரி மாணவியாக படிப்பைத் தொடருகிறேன். இவ்வாய்வுக் கற்கையை நடத்துவதற்கு, நான் கிளிநொச்சி மாவட்டத்தில் உள்ள அரசு பாடசாலைக்குச் செல்ல வேண்டியுள்ளது. கிளிநொச்சி மாவட்டத்திலுள்ள தரம் 9 முதல் 11 வரை கல்வி கற்கும் பாடசாலை மாணவிகளிடம் மாதவிடாய்க் கால சுகாதாரம் தொடர்பான அறிவும், பின்பற்றும் நடைமுறையும் சம்பந்தமான மதிப்பீடு செய்ய வேண்டியுள்ளது.

ஆய்வின் நோக்கம்

ஒரு பெண்ணின் பிரத்தியேக மரியாதையையும், திருப்தியான வாழ்க்கையையும் மேம்படுத்துவதற்கு தானே தன்னை கவனிக்கும் நடைமுறையும், மாதவிடாய்க் கால சுகாதாரமும் அடிப்படைத் தேவைகளாகும். ஆகையினால், கிளிநொச்சி மாவட்டத்தில் தரம் 9 முதல் 11 வரையுள்ள பாடசாலை பருவமடைந்த (பூப்பெய்திய) மாணவிகள் மத்தியில் காணப்படும் மாதவிடாய்க் கால சுகாதாரம் பற்றிய அறிவும், தன்னைத்தானே கவனித்துக் கொள்ளும் நடைமுறைகள் பற்றியும் நுண்ணாய்வு செய்வது அவசியமாகும். மாதவிடாய்க் கால சுகாதாரத்தை மிக உயர்ந்த தரத்தில் பேணுவதையும் பின்பற்றுதல் குழந்தை உருவாகும் வழித் தொற்று நோய்களையும் கருப்பை வாசல் குறுவழிப் புற்று நோயையும் தடுப்பதில் பெண்கள் மத்தியில் பெரும்பங்கு ஆற்றுகிறது. வளர்ந்த பள்ளிக்கூட மாணவிகள் மத்தியில் மாதவிடாய் முகாமைத்துவத்திலும், அதனோடு இணைந்த பிரச்சனைகளிலும் சாதகமான போக்கை அதிகரிப்பதுமே இவ்வாய்வு செய்வதின் நோக்கமாகும்.

தன்னார்வுப் பங்குபற்றல்

இவ் வாய்வில் நீங்கள் பங்கு பற்றுதல் முற்றுமுழுதுமாக தன்னார்வமானது. இதில் பங்குவதோ இல்லையோ என்பது தங்களது தேர்வாகும். இக் கற்கையில் நீங்கள் பங்குபற்றுவதில்லை எனத் தீர்மானித்தால் எப்பொழுதும் அதனைச் செய்யலாம், இசைவு கொடுத்த பின்பும் கூட.

கற்கையின் காலம், கற்கையின் நடைமுறைகள் அத்துடன் பங்குபற்றுனரின் பொறுப்புக்கள் கிளிநொச்சி மாவட்டத்திலுள்ள அரசு பாடசாலைகளில் தரம் 9 முதல் 11 கற்கும் பாடசாலை மாணவிகள் மத்தியில் ஆய்வு செய்யப்படவுள்ளது. உங்களுக்கு சில வினாக்களை அடங்கிய வினாக்கொத்து வழங்கப்படும். அவ் வினாக்கொத்தைப் பூரணப்படுத்தவதற்கு உங்களுக்கு 5-15 நிமிடங்கள் செல்லும்.

மறைந்திருக்கும் நன்மைகள்

இக் கற்கை பங்குபற்றுனருக்கு, மாதவிடாய்க் கால சுகாதாரத்தில் அறிவும், குழந்தை உருவாகும் வழித் தொற்று நோய்களைப் பற்றிய விழிப்புணர்வு மேம்படுத்தி வாழ்க்கை முறை மாற்றி நல்ல சுகாதார வழிகாட்டல்களுடன் வாழ உதவிடும்.

ஆபத்துக்கள், அழிவுகள், வசதியீனங்கள்

இக் கற்கையினில் ஈடுபடுவதினால் உமக்கு ஆபத்துக்களோ, அழிவுகளோ, வசதியீனங்களோ ஏற்பட மாட்டாது.

கற்கையில் பங்குபற்றுதலை முடிவுறுத்தல்

நீர், தண்டனையோ, வைத்தியக் கவனிப்பில் தாக்கமோ, நன்மைகளின் இழப்போ எதுவுமின்றி, இக் கற்கையில் பங்கு பற்றுதலை பற்றிய ஒப்பதலை, எந்நேரமும், திரும்பப் பெற்றுக் கொள்ளலாம்.

செலவழித்ததை மீளப்பெறல்

இவ் வாய்வில் பங்கேற்றமைக்கு எவ்வித ஊக்குவிப்பும் வழங்கப்பட மாட்டாது.

தெளிவுபடுத்தல்

சில சொற்கள் உங்களுக்கு விளங்காதவையாக இருக்கும். தகவல் பற்றி நாம் பார்க்கும் போது, என்னிடம் நிற்பாட்டும் படி கேட்கவும். நான் அதனை, கால அவகாசம் எடுத்து அதனை விளங்கப் படுத்துவேன். நீங்கள் கேள்விகள் கேட்க வேண்டுமாயின், பின்பு, நீங்கள் என்னிடம் கேட்கலாம்.

ANNEXURE V

INFORMATION SHEET

I am an undergraduate student, who is following a degree on Biomedical Science at Management and Science University, Colombo. To conduct this research study, I have to visit government schools in Kilinochchi district and obtain necessary data to survey of level of knowledge and practices regarding Menstrual Hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in Kilinochchi District.

Purpose of the Research

Self-care practices as well as menstrual hygiene are basic requirements for promoting a satisfied life and personal esteem in a woman. Therefore, it is necessary to investigate the knowledge and self-care practices of menstrual hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls who have attained menarche in Kilinochchi District. Adoption of high quality menstrual hygiene plays an important role in the prevention of Reproductive Tract Infections (RTI) and Cancer of cervix among the women population. The purpose of doing this research is to promote positive attitudes towards management of menstruation and related problems among the adolescent school girls.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation in this research is entirely voluntary. It is your choice whether to participate or not. If you decide not to participate for the study, you may do at any time even after giving consent.

Time of study, procedures of the study and participants responsibilities

The study will be carried out among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls from government schools in Kilinochchi district. You will be given some questions using a questionnaire, it will take 5-15 minutes for you to complete the questionnaire.

Potential benefits

This study will help participants to get a general idea regarding knowledge and practices on menstrual hygiene and to improve awareness of RTI and change their life style to good health directions.

Risks, hazards and discomforts

There will be no risks, hazards and discomforts for you by attending this study.

Termination of the study participation

You may withdraw your consent to participate in this study at any time, with no penalty or effect on medical care or loss of benefits. Please notify the investigator as soon as you decide to withdraw your consent.

Reimbursements

You will not be provided any incentive to take part in the research.

Clarification

There may be some words that you do not understand. Please ask me to stop as we go through the information and I will take time to explain. If you have questions later, you can ask them from me.

කැමැත්ත පළ කරන ආකෘති පත්‍රය

ත්‍රිපුනාවේ දිස්ත්‍රික්කයේ පාසල්වල් 9 වන ශ්‍රේණියේ සිට 11 වන ශ්‍රේණිය දක්වා ස්ත්‍රී පාරිභෝගික
පිළිබඳ දැනුවත් කිරීමේ වාර්තාව

සහභාගි වන අය විසින් සම්පූර්ණ කළ යුතුයි.

සහභාගි වන අය ම මෙම සම්පූර්ණ ආකෘති පත්‍රය ම ඔහු / ඇය විසින් සම්පූර්ණ කළ යුතුවේ.

(ඔබගේ තේරීම වට රවුමක් දමා ලකුණු කරන්න)

1. තොරතුරු පත්‍රිකාව කියවුවේද ?
(ඔබ වෙනුවෙන්) ඔව්/ නැහැ
2. මෙම පර්යේෂණය සම්බන්ධයෙන් සාකච්ඡා කිරීමටත් එක්
අයෙක් තබා ගැනීමටත් ප්‍රශ්න ඇසීමටත් ඔබට අවස්ථාවක් ලැබුණේද ? ඔව්/ නැහැ
3. ඔබගේ සියලුම ප්‍රශ්න වලට තෘප්තිමත් පිළිතුරක් ලැබුණාද ? ඔව්/ නැහැ
4. මෙම පර්යේෂණය ගැන අවශ්‍ය තොරතුරු ලැබුණාද ? ඔව් /නැහැ
5. මෙම පර්යේෂණය ගැන ඔබට පැහැදිලි කළේ කවිද ?
6. හේතුවක් නොකියා ,පර්යේෂණයෙන් ඕනෑම වේලාවක
අත්හැර ඉවත් විය හැකි නිදහස ඔබට ඇති බව ඔබ දන්නවාද ? ඔව්/ නැහැ
7. තීරණයකට එළඹීමට ඔබට ප්‍රමාණවත් කල් වේලා තිබුණාද? ඔව් /නැහැ
8. මෙම පර්යේෂණයට සහභාගිවීමට ඔබ කැමතිද ? ඔව් /නැහැ

සහභාගි වන ශිෂ්‍යාවගේ දෙමව්පියන් / භාරකරුවන්-

දිනය..... අත්සන.....

නම(capital).....

නිරීක්ෂණය කරන අය විසින් සම්පූර්ණ කළ යුතුයි.

මෙම පර්යේෂණය ගැන ඉහත සඳහන් ස්වේච්ඡා අයට මා පැහැදිලි කළෙමි .ඔහු / ඇය මෙයට සහභාගිවීමට කැමැත්ත පළ කර තිබේ.

නිරීක්ෂණයේ යෙදෙන අයගේ අත්සන.....

මෙම පර්යේෂණය ගැන ඉහත සඳහන් ස්වේච්ඡා අයට මා පැහැදිලි කළෙමි .ඔහු / ඇය මෙයට සහභාගිවීමට කැමැත්ත පළ කර තිබේ.

නිරීක්ෂණයේ යෙදෙන අයගේ අත්සන.....

දිනය.....

නම(capital).....

සහභාගි වන අයට මෙම **කියා** පිළිවෙත පැහැදිලි කිරීමේදී මා පෙනී සිටිය බවත් මෙම පර්යේෂණයට සහභාගි වීමට ඔහු / ඇය කැමැත්ත පළ කිරීමට මා සාක්ෂියක් ලෙසද සිටියෙමි.

සාක්ෂිකරුවාගේ අත්සන.....

සාක්ෂිකරු මෙම පර්යේෂණයට සම්බන්ධ අයෙක්ව නොසිටිය යුතුයි.

දිනය.....

නම(capital).....

ANNEXURE VII

இசைவுப்படிவம்

இலங்கை, கிளிநொச்சி மாவட்டத்தில் தரம் 9 முதல் 11 வரை கல்வி கற்கும் பெண் பிள்ளைகள் மத்தியில் காணப்படும் மாதவிடாய்க்கால சுகாதாரமும், அது பற்றிய அறிவும், பின்பற்றும் நடைமுறைகளும்

பங்கு பற்றுனரால் பூரணப்படுத்த வேண்டியது.

பங்கு பற்றுனர் இந்த தாள் முழுவதையும் முழுவதுமாக முடிக்க வேண்டும் (உங்கள் விருப்பப்படி தெரிவைச் சுற்றி ஒரு வட்டத்தை இடுங்கள்).

1. நீங்கள் தகவல் தாளைப் படித்தீர்களா? (தயவுசெய்து ஒரு நகலை வைத்திருங்கள்) ஆம்/இல்லை
2. இந்த ஆய்வு பற்றிக் கலந்துரையாவும் கேள்விகள் கேட்கவும் உங்களுக்கு சந்தர்ப்பம் கிடைத்ததா? ஆம்/இல்லை
3. உங்கள் எல்லா கேள்விகளுக்கும் நீங்கள் திருப்திகரமான பதில்களைக் கொண்டிருந்தீர்களா? ஆம்/இல்லை
4. இவ் வாய்வு பற்றி போதுமான தகவலை நீங்கள் பெற்றுள்ளீர்களா? ஆம்/இல்லை
5. இவ் வாய்வு பற்றி உங்களுக்கு விளங்கப்படுத்தியது யார்.....
6. காரணத்தைக் கூறாமல் எந்த நேரத்திலும் இவ் வாய்விலிருந்து நீங்கள் விலகிச் செல்லலாம் என்பதை நீங்கள் அறிவீர்களா? ஆம்/இல்லை
7. ஒரு தீர்மானத்திற்கு வருவதற்கு உங்களுக்கு போதுமான கால அவகாசம் இருந்ததா? ஆம்/இல்லை
8. இந்த ஆய்வில் பங்கெடுக்க நீங்கள் விரும்புகிறீர்களா? ஆம்/இல்லை

பங்குபெறும் மாணவர்களின் பெற்றோர் /பாதுகாவலர் கையொப்பம்.....
திகதி.....

பெயர் (தனி எழுத்துக்களில்).....

புலனாய்வு செய்பவரால் பூரணப்படுத்தப்பட வேண்டும்.

மேலேயுள்ள தன்னார்வலரிடம் ஆய்வுகளை நான் விளக்கினேன், அவர் / அவள் பங்கேற்க விருப்பம் தெரிவித்துள்ளார்.

புலனாய்வு செய்பவரின் கையொப்பம்.....

திகதி.....

பெயர் (தனி எழுத்துக்களில்).....

பங்குபற்றுனருக்கு இந் நடைமுறையை விளங்கப்படுத்தும் போது நான் பிரசன்னமாக இருந்ததாகவும், இவ் வாய்வில் பங்கு பற்றுவதற்கு அவர்/அவள் விருப்பம் தெரிவித்தமைக்கு நான் சாட்சியாகவும் இருந்தேன்.

சாட்சியின் கையொப்பம்.....

(இவ் வாய்வுடன், சாட்சி தொடர்புடையவராக இருக்கக் கூடாது)

திகதி.....

பெயர் (தனி எழுத்துக்களில்).....

ANNEXURE VIII
CONSENT FORM

Knowledge and practices regarding menstrual hygiene among grade 9 to grade 11 school girls in government schools in Kilinochchi district, Sri Lanka

To be completed by the participant

The participant should complete the whole of this sheet himself/herself (Put a circle at your choice).

- | | |
|---|---------|
| 1. Have you read the information sheet? (Please keep a copy for yourself) | YES/ NO |
| 2. Have you had an opportunity to discuss this study and ask any questions? | YES/ NO |
| 3. Have you had satisfactory answers to all your questions? | YES/ NO |
| 4. Have you received enough information about the study? | YES/ NO |
| 5. Who explained the study to you? | |
| 6. Do you understand that you are free to withdraw from the study at any time, without giving a reason? | YES/ NO |
| 7. Have you had sufficient time to come into a decision? | YES/ NO |
| 8. Do you agree to take part in this study? | YES/ NO |

Participate student parents / guardian signature.....

Date

Name (BLOCK CAPITALS)

To be completed by the investigator I have explained the study to the above volunteer and he/she has indicated her willingness to take part.

Signature of the investigator

Date

Name (BLOCK CAPITALS)

I have been present while the procedure has been explained to the participant and I have witnessed his/her consent to take part in the study.

Signature of witness

(The witness should be person NOT connected with the study)

Date.....

Name (BLOCK CAPITALS)

ANNEXURE IX

කිලිනොච්චි දිස්ත්‍රික්කයේ පාසල්වල 9 වන ශ්‍රේණියේ 11 ශ්‍රේණිය දක්වා ඉගෙනුම ලබන ශිෂ්‍යයන්ගේ ඔප්පුව හා ඒ සම්බන්ධ කියාපවිච්ඡා

‘✓’ ලකුණු කිරීමෙන් හෝ සපයන ලද ඉඩෙහි නිවැරදි පිළිතුරු සපයන්න.

Aකොටස - සාමාන්‍ය - ජනගහන සාදක

1. වයස අවුරුදු.....	2. ඔබ අයත් ආගම කුමක්ද? a. බුද්ධාගම ☐ b. හින්දු ☐ c. ඉස්ලාම් ☐ d. ක්‍රිස්තියානි ☐
3. මවගේ අධ්‍යාපන මට්ටම a. පාසල් අධ්‍යාපනයක් නැත ☐ b. ප්‍රාථමික අධ්‍යාපනය ☐ c. සා/පෙළ ☐ d. උ/පෙළ ☐ e. උපාධ්‍යවර්ණයක් ☐	4. පියාගේ අධ්‍යාපන මට්ටම a. පාසල් අධ්‍යාපනයක් නැත ☐ b. ප්‍රාථමික අධ්‍යාපනය ☐ c. සා/පෙළ ☐ d. උ/පෙළ ☐ e. උපාධ්‍යවර්ණයක් ☐
5. ඔබේ පියාගේ රැකියාව? ඔබේ මවගේ රැකියාව? 	6. පවුලේ මාසික ආදායම (රුපියල්) a. < 9,999 ☐ b. 10,000 - 29,999 ☐ c. 30,000 - 59,999 ☐ d. 60,000 - 89,999 ☐ e. > 90,000 ☐
7. ඔබගේ පවුලේ සාමාජිකයින් ගණන 	8. ඔබට සහෝදර සහෝදරියන් සිටීද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐ සිටිනම් සහෝදර සහෝදරියන් ගණන?
9. ඔබ උගත් වියයන් තුල සෞඛ්‍ය හා ගාර්ථික අධ්‍යාපනය ලබා තිබේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	10. ඔබගේ නිවසේ වැසිකිලියක් තිබේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐

B කොටස - යොවුන් පාසල් බාලිකාවන්ගේ ඔප්පත්

11. ඔබ මල්වර වී තිබේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐ එසේ නම්, මල්වරවන වයස (අවුරුද්ද) 	12. ඔබේ ඔප්පත් කොපමණ කාලයක් පවතීද?
13. ආර්තව චක්‍රය කොපමණ දින ගණනක්ද? (දවස්) a. <28 ☐ b. 28-32 ☐ c. >32 ☐	

C කොටස - ඔප්පත් පිළිබඳ දැනුම

14. ඔප්පත් යනු රෝගයකි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	15. ඔප්පත්වල දින කිහිපයකට පෙර සුදු පැහැති ශ්‍රාවයක් පිටවීම සාමාන්‍යයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
16. ඔප්පත් යනු යෝනියෙන් ලේ ගැලීමයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	17. ඔප්පත්වලට හෝමෝන හේතුවක් නොවේ. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
18. දුර්වල ඔප්ප් සනීපාරක්ෂාව ආශ්වාද වලට හේතුවේ. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	19. ඔප්පත්වල දින දෙකක් හමයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
20. ඔසප් රැඳිරය අපිරිසිදුයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	21. ඔප්පත්වල දින දෙකට පමණක් හිතර සේදිය යුතුය. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
22. සනීපාරක්ෂක තුවා සහ රෙදි හිතර හිතර සේදිය යුතුය. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	23. ප්‍රේමය සනීපාරක්ෂාව ඔප්පත්වල වේදනාව වැඩිවයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
24. අවධිගත ඔප්පත් සාරවත්ව පෙන්වයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	25. ඔප්පත්වල දින දෙකට පමණක් හිතර සේදිය යුතුය. a. සනීපාරක්ෂක තුවා ☐ b. රෙදි ☐

26. අධික රුධිර වහනය රක්තනිනතාවට මහපාදයි. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	27. ඔබේ ඔසප්වීම දින 8 කට වඩා වැඩි උවහෙහේ ඔබ වෛද්‍යවරයෙකු හමුවිය යුතුයි? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
28. ඔසප්වීමේදී ගැහැණු ළමයින් මහද ආහාර පරිභෝජනය කළ යුතුය. a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	

D කොටස ඔසප් සහිතාරක්ෂාව සබන්ධ ප්‍රශ්නවලි.

29. ඔබ භාවිතා කරන කුමන වර්ගයේ අවශෝෂකයක්ද? a. සහිතාරක්ෂක තුවා ☐ b. රෙදි ☐	30. භාමිකා කරන අවශෝෂක ඔබ කොපමණ වෙලාවකින් මාද කරනවාද?
31. ඔබ පාසලේදී ඔබේ අවශෝෂනය මාද කරනවාද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	32. ඔබ රෙදි භාවිතාකරනවානම් එය කාමරයේ වියලන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
33. ඔබ රෙදි භාවිතා කරයි නම් එය පිරිසිදු හා ආවරණවූ ස්ථානයක තබන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	34. ඔබ භාවිතාකල රෙදි වැසිකිලියට දමන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
33. ඔබ රෙදි භාවිතා කරයි නම් එය පිරිසිදු හා ආවරණවූ ස්ථානයක තබන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	34. ඔබ භාවිතාකල රෙදි වැසිකිලියට දමන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
35. ඔබ ඔසප් කාලය තුළ දිනපතා ස්නානය කරනවාද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	36. ඔබ ඔසප් කාලය තුළ නින්දට යාමට පෙර ලිංගාශ්‍රිත ප්‍රදේශය පිරිසිදු කරනවාද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
37. ලිංගාශ්‍රිත ප්‍රදේශය පිරිසිදු කිරීමේදී ඔබ ජලය පමණක් භාවිතා කරන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	38. මෙහිදී සැම අවස්ථාවකදීම ඔබ වැසිකිලිය භාවිතා කරන විට අත් සෝදන්නේද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐
39. අවශෝෂනය වෙනස් කිරීමෙන් පසු ඔබ ඔබේ අත් සේදීම සිදුකරයිද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐	40. ඔසප්කාලය තුල ඔබ වෙනම යට ඇඳුම් භාවිතා කිරීම සිදුකරයිද? a. ඔව් ☐ b. නැත ☐

ANNEXURE X

கேள்வித்தாள்

கிளிநொச்சி மாவட்டத்தில் அமைந்துள்ள அரசாங்கப் பாடசாலைகளில் தரம் 9 முதல் 11 வரை கல்வி கற்கும் பெண் பிள்ளைகள் மத்தியில் காணப்படும் மாதவிடாய்க்கால சுகாதாரமும், அது பற்றிய அறிவும், பின்பற்றும் நடைமுறைகளும் தொடர்பான மதிப்பாய்வு

பின்வரும் கேள்விகளுக்கு சரியானபதிலை தெரிவுசெய்து

வழங்கப்பட்ட இடத்தில் “✓” அடையாளம் இடுக அல்லது இடைவெளியை நிரப்புக.

பகுதி அ: சமூக - ஜனத்தொகை காரணிகள்

1. வயது (வருடங்களில்) 	2. நீங்கள் எந்த மதத்தைச் சேர்ந்தவர்? a. பௌத்த மதம் ☐ b. இந்து மதம் ☐ c. இஸ்லாம் ☐ d. கிறிஸ்தவம் ☐
3. தாயின் கல்வித் தகைமை a. பாடசாலைக் கல்வி ☐ பெறப்படவில்லை ☐ b. ஆரம்பக் கல்வி ☐ c. சாதாரண தரம் ☐ d. உயர்தரம் ☐ e. பட்டம் பெற்றவர் ☐	4. தந்தையின் கல்வித் தகைமை a. பாடசாலைக் கல்வி ☐ பெறப்படவில்லை ☐ b. ஆரம்பக் கல்வி ☐ c. சாதாரண தரம் ☐ d. உயர்தரம் ☐ e. பட்டம் பெற்றவர் ☐
5. உங்கள் தந்தையின் தொழில் உங்கள் தாயின் தொழில் 	6. குடும்ப மாதாந்த வருமானம் (ரூபாயில்) a. 0 – 9,999 ☐ b. 10,000 – 29,999 ☐ c. 30,000 – 59,999 ☐ d. 60,000 – 89,999 ☐ e. 90,000க்கும் அதிகமாக ☐
7. உங்கள் குடும்பத்தில் எத்தனை அங்கத்தவர்கள் இருக்கிறார்கள்? 	8. உங்களுக்கு உடன் பிறந்தவர்கள் உள்ளனரா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐ ஆம் எனில், எத்தனை சகோதரிகள் மற்றும் சகோதரர்களை கொண்டுள்ளீர்கள்? சகோதரிகள்..... சகோதரர்கள்.....
9. நீங்கள் சுகாதாரமும் உடற்கல்வியும் எனும் விடயத்தை உங்கள் பாடங்களில் கொண்டுள்ளீர்களா? ☐ a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	10. உங்கள் வீட்டில் மறைப்பான கழிப்பறையைக் கொண்டுள்ளீர்களா? ☐ a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐

பகுதி ஆ: கட்டிளமைப் பருவ பாடசாலைப் பெண் பிள்ளைகளில் மாதவிடாய்க் கோலங்கள்

11. நீங்கள் பூப்பெய்து விட்டீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐ ஆம் எனில், பூப்பெய்திய வயது (வருடங்களில்)	12. உங்களது மாதவிடாய் எத்தனை நாட்கள் நீடிக்கும்?
13. மாதவிடாய் வட்டத்தின் நீட்சி(நாட்களில்) a. <28 ☐ b. 28-32 ☐ c. >32 ☐	

பகுதி இ: மாதவிடாய்க்கால சுகாதாரம் பற்றிய அறிவு

14. மாதவிடாய் ஒரு நோய் நிலைமைக்குரிய செயற்பாடாகும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	15. மாதவிடாய்க்கு ஒரு சில நாட்களுக்கு முன்பு வெள்ளை வெளியீடு விடுவிக்கப்படுதல் அசாதாரணமான நிலையாகும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
16. மாதவிடாய் என்பது யோனிவழியினூடான இரத்தப் போக்கு ஆகும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	17. ஒமோன்கள்,மாதவிடாய்க்கான காரணங்கள் அல்ல. a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
18. முறையற்ற மாதவிடாய் சுகாதாரமானது நோய்த் தொற்றுக்கு வழி வகுக்கும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	19. மாதவிடாயின் போது துர்நாற்றம் வீசுகிறது. a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
20. மாதவிடாய்ப் போக்கின் இரத்தம் அசுத்தமானது. a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	21. மாதவிடாயின் போது பிறப்புறுப்புகள் அடிக்கடி கழுவப்பட வேண்டியவையாகும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
22. சுகாதாரத் திண்டுகள்/துணிகள் அடிக்கடி மாற்றப்பட வேண்டியவை. a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	23. தனிப்பட்ட உடற்சுகாதாரம் மாதவிடாய் வலியைத் தவிர்க்கும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
24. ஒழுங்கீனமான மாதவிடாய் கருத்தரித்திருப்பதைக் குறிக்கிறது. a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	25. மாதவிடாயின் போது எந்த உறிஞ்சும் பொருள் பலவகையிலும் பயன்படுத்துவதற்கு உகந்தது? a. சுகாதாரத் திண்டு ☐ b. துணி ☐

26. அதீத இரத்தப் போக்கு குருதிச் சோகைக்கு இட்டுச் செல்லும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	27. உங்கள் மாதவிடாய் 8 நாட்களுக்கு அதிகமாக நீடித்தால், நீங்கள் ஒரு மருத்துவரை அணுக வேண்டும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
28. மாதவிடாயின் போது பெண்கள் கட்டாயம் கடல் உணவை உட் கொடுக்க வேண்டும். a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	

பகுதி ஈ: மாதவிடாய்க்கால சுகாதாரம் பற்றிய பின்பற்றும் நடைமுறைகள்

29. எந்த வகையான உறிஞ்சும் பொருளை நீங்கள் பயன்படுத்துகின்றீர்கள்? a. சுகாதாரத் திண்டு ☐ b. துணி ☐	30. நாளொன்றுக்கு எத்தனை தடவைகள் உங்கள் திண்டு/துணிகளை மாற்றுகின்றீர்கள்?
31. நீங்கள் பாடசாலையில் உங்கள் உறிஞ்சும் பொருளை மாற்றுவதுண்டா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	32. நீங்கள் துணியைப் பாவிக்கின்றீர்கள் எனில், அதனை கழுவிய பின் அறையின் உள்ளே உலர்த்துகின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
33. நீங்கள் துணியைப் பாவிக்கின்றீர்கள் எனில், நீங்கள் அதை சுத்தமான மற்றும் மூடப்பட்ட இடத்தில் சேமித்து வைக்கின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	34. நீங்கள் கழிப்பறைக் குழிக்குள் திண்டு / துணியை வீசுகின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
35. உங்கள் மாதவிடாயின் போது நீங்கள் தினமும் குளிக்கின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	36. மாதவிடாய்க் காலத்தில் நித்திரைக்கு செல்வதற்கு முன்பு மட்டுமே உங்கள் பிறப்புறுப்பை சுத்தப்படுத்துவீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
37. மாதவிடாயின் போது உங்கள் புறப்பாலுறுப்புக்களை நீங்கள் தண்ணீரால் மாத்திரம் சுத்தம் செய்கின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	38. ஒவ்வொரு முறையும் கழிப்பறையை உபயோகிக்கும் போது, மாதவிடாய் காலத்தில் உங்கள் கைகளை கழுவுவீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐
39. திண்டு/துணிகளை மாற்றிய பின்பு உங்கள் கைகளை நீங்கள் தண்ணீராலும் சவர்க்காரத்தாலும் கழுவுகின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐	40. மாதவிடாயின் போது நீங்கள் வேறுபிரிக்கப்பட்ட உள்ளடைகளைப் பயன்படுத்துகின்றீர்களா? a. ஆம் ☐ b. இல்லை ☐

ANNEXURE XI

KNOWLEDGE AND PRACTICES REGARDING MENSTRUAL HYGIENE AMONG GRADE 9 TO GRADE 11 SCHOOL GIRLS IN GOVERNMENT SCHOOLS IN KILINOCHCHI DISTRICT, SRI LANKA

Indicate the correct answer to the following questions by marking “✓”, or by writing in the space provided.

Section A: socio-demographic factors

1. Age in years.....	2. Which religion do you belong to? a. Buddhism <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> b. Hinduism <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> c. Islam <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> d. Christianity <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/>
3. Education level of Mother <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> a. No-schooling <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> b. Primary education <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> c. O/L <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> d. A/L <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> e. Degree holder <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/>	4. Education level of father a. No-schooling <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> b. Primary education <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> c. O/L <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> d. A/L <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> e. Degree holder <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/>
5. What is your father's occupation? What is your mother's occupation?	6. Family monthly income (in Rupees) a. 0 – 9,999 <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> b. 10,000 - 29,999 <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> c. 30,000 - 59,999 <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> d. 60,000 - 89,999 <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> e. >90,000 <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/>
7. How many members are there in your family?	8. Do you have siblings? <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> a. Yes <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> b. No <input style="float: right;" type="checkbox"/> If yes, how many sisters and brothers do you have? sisters..... brothers

9. Do you have health and physical education in your subjects? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	10. Do you have a covered toilet in your house? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
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Section B: menstrual pattern in adolescent school girls

11. Have you attained menarche? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐ If yes, age at menarche(yrs)	12. How many days does your period last?.....
13. Length of cycle(days) a. <28 ☐ b. 28-32 ☐ c. >32 ☐	

Section C: Menstrual hygiene knowledge

14. Menstruation is a disease process. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	15. Release of a white discharge a few days before menstruation is abnormal. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
16. Menstruation is bleeding from vagina. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	17. Hormones are not the cause of menstruation. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
18. Poor menstrual hygiene predisposes to infection. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	19. There is foul smell during menstruation. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
20. Menstrual blood is unhygienic. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	21. Genitalia should be washed frequently during menstruation. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
22. Pad/cloths should be changed frequently. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	23. Personal hygiene prevents menstrual pain. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐

24. Irregular menstruation is an indication of fertility. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	25. Which absorbent should ideally be used during menstruation? a. Sanitary pads ☐ b. A cloth ☐
26. Excessive bleeding leads to anemia. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	27. If your menstruation last for more than 8 days, you should see a doctor. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
28. During menstruation, girls must consume sea food. a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	

Session D: Practices related to menstrual hygiene

29. Which type of absorbent are you using? a. Sanitary pads ☐ b. A Cloth ☐	30. How frequent are you changing your pad/cloths per day?
31. Do you change your absorbent in school? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	32. If you are using cloth, do you dry it inside the room? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
33. If you are using cloth, do you store it in a clean and covered place? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	34. Do you throw pad/cloth in to the latrine? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
35. Do you bathe daily during your menstruation? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	36. Before going to sleep do you clean your genitalia during menstruation? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
37. Do you clean your genitalia only with water during menstruation? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	38. Every time while using toilet do you wash your hands during menstruation? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐
39. Do you wash your hands with water and soap after changing absorbents? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐	40. Do you use separate undergarments during menstruation? a. Yes ☐ b. No ☐